

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 827

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Emmett L. Bolyard of Bolivar.

WHEREAS, we were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Emmett L. Bolyard of Bolivar; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolyard was an exemplary public servant and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolyard was born on February 1, 1939, in Columbiana, Ohio, and moved to Tennessee in 1963; as a young man, he served in the U.S. Army Reserve; and

WHEREAS, Emmett Bolyard joined the Bolivar Fire Department on January 1, 1964, beginning what would become an extraordinary legacy of commitment and sacrifice; and

WHEREAS, he was later hired as a career firefighter, becoming the first paid firefighter within Bolivar; he was promoted to captain in 1970 and assistant chief in 1994, roles he filled with integrity, humility, and devotion; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolyard received the coveted Firefighter of the Year Award once in 1982 and again in 2002; he provided unwavering service until 2001, when he reached his mandatory retirement age of sixty-two, but he remained an active volunteer firefighter until 2025; and

WHEREAS, in total, Emmett Bolyard gave selflessly to the Bolivar community for more than sixty-one years as a firefighter; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his firefighting career, Mr. Bolyard served as a reserve school bus driver for Hardeman County Schools, helped run the ambulance service in Hardeman County, and worked at the Jervis Corporation; and

WHEREAS, a man of deep faith, Emmett Bolyard was an active member of Bolivar's First Methodist Church, where he served as custodian for over fifteen years; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolyard was also deeply devoted to his family, and he took great pride in caring for them, always remaining true to family values of the highest order; he cherished time spent with his grandchildren and was always there to support them in their sporting endeavors; and

WHEREAS, beyond spending time with his family, Emmett Bolyard enjoyed the simple pleasures in life, including watching *The Young and the Restless*; and

WHEREAS, he will be sadly mourned but fondly remembered by his two sons, William "B.J." (Becky) Bolyard and Craig Bolyard; grandchildren, Shelby Bolyard Parker, Alyssa Bolyard, Lindy Bolyard, Kadea Bolyard, Abby Bolyard Ruble, Cody Bolyard, Austin Bolyard, Tanner Parker, Tucker Parker, and Abbie Parker; great-grandchildren, Jackson Jewell Bolyard, Emma Lee Bolyard, Nash Allen Bolyard, Harper Grace Ruble, Maverick Ross Parker, and MacKenzie Blake Parker; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Bolyard was preceded in death by his beloved wife, Patricia Bowers Bolyard; daughter, Linda Bolyard Evans; father, Truman P. Bolyard; mother, Thelma Grace Kurtz Bolyard; and daughter-in-law, Sherelle Bolyard; and

WHEREAS, Emmett Bolyard leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Emmett L. Bolyard,

reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Bolyard.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.